

Release of In-person module-cohorts

Frequently Asked Questions

Context

The senior leadership of ALU has decided to provide in-person options for modules taken by students of ALU Rwanda. This decision is informed by feedback from students, faculty, and external stakeholders and the university's commitment to providing a quality learning experience for its students. In 2024, the university piloted a hybrid model (classes delivered synchronously in person and online) for some modules to test student interest in returning to campus for lectures. The response was encouraging and the pilot provided key insights about our delivery model. This transition is an evolution from the 1T (in-person) + 8T (online) structure to a more immersive, flexible, and student-centered approach, offering expanded in-person learning, and richer experiential opportunities.

Details

This transition from an online and hybrid delivery model to a blended learning model will begin in the May 2025 trimester. No modules will be delivered in a hybrid format. Starting in May 2025, students will be able to opt in for an online or an in-person cohort transition will begin with 15 modules: BEL (9) and BSE (6). See the detailed list below. More modules will be added to the list in subsequent trimesters.

This transition will increase structured and organic opportunities for ALU Rwanda's students to engage with and immerse in our Pan-African community while utilizing our beautiful campus. We encourage students to take advantage of the increased presence of students on campus to host student events, network, set up/grow student ventures, and continue doing the hard things. The Student Life team is excited about the transition and is available to support students who are keen to take the lead in curating these opportunities.

Criteria for in-person cohorts.

Modes of delivery for selected modules will be confirmed after term registration closes, depending on the number of students who sign up for the in-person cohorts. An in-person cohort must have at least 15 students enrolled to be eligible for implementation. Cohorts with fewer students will be delivered in an online format.

Purpose of this Document.

We recognize that students will have many questions about this evolution, so this document details responses to some of the questions we suspect you will have. If you have a question that hasn't been answered, please submit it [here](#).

Frequently Asked Questions

1. Why is the university providing in-person cohorts?

The senior leadership of ALU has decided to provide in-person options for modules taken by students of ALU Rwanda. This decision is informed by feedback from students, faculty, and external stakeholders and the university's commitment to providing a quality learning experience for its students.

2. Will there still be hybrid courses?

No, all modules will now be delivered either online or in person. However, if we have a session that requires both students online and in-person to attend at the same time, we will create a hybrid session.

3. Which modules can I take in person?

For the May 2025 trimester, there are 9 modules in the BSE with an in-person variant and 6 in BEL. The full list is in the [Annex](#) below.

Additionally, students taking online sections can still sign up for and attend office hours in person with faculty on campus.

4. If I choose an in-person cohort, can I switch to an online cohort? What about if I choose an online cohort. Can I switch to an in-person cohort?

The learning experience for in-person cohorts is designed for in-person engagement involving specific activities tailored for in-class group work and peer learning. Online classes also have specific activities tailored to an online learning environment. Therefore, switching cohorts will impact your learning experience as well as that of your cohort (Ex: Peer Work).

If a student has an emergency that requires them to be absent from class for a few sessions, they can request an approved absence via the [usual leave of absence request process](#) (see section 19 of the Assessment Policy).

In exceptional circumstances, such as medical or family emergencies, the request should be **reported via email** to the Program Lead, Associate Director of Academics, and Student Life Manager to evaluate the need for a permanent switch to an online cohort. The Associate Director of Academics will then approve the request and have the switch made officially.

If you opt into an in-person cohort and do not fulfill the minimum required attendance, you will lose the associated grades for attendance and engagement.

5. Is there a limit to in-person cohort size or the number of in-person cohorts in a module?

Each of the selected modules will have a maximum of 2 in-person cohorts. The BEL modules have a minimum cohort size of 15 and a maximum of 40 students, while BSE modules have a minimum cohort size of 20 and a maximum of 40 students. An

exception will be made to the specialization tracks - Low Level Programming and Augmented/Virtual Reality where the total enrollment is usually less than 10. The Trimester-6 modules in these tracks will have only one variant (either in-person or online) depending on the registration numbers.

6. Will the content be the same for in-person and online cohorts?

Yes, the learning objectives, content, resources, and assessments will be the same for both variants of a module. The only difference will be the mode of delivery. We encourage students to participate fully in whichever variant they choose so they can enjoy the full experience of the module's delivery by being physically and mentally present in class, turning on their cameras in the online variant, doing the necessary pre-work, and actively participating in the module.

7. Can I choose in-person for one module and online for another module in the same trimester?

Yes. Since not all modules have an in-person modality, all students will still take some of their modules online.

8. What will be the delivery mode of modules running in parallel with the Skills Immersion module?

For the May trimester, all courses running parallel to Skills Immersion modules only have a virtual variant. For subsequent trimesters and changes, you may refer the [Annex](#) section.

9. When will we choose our cohorts?

As usual, students will select their cohorts during registration. For courses with an in-person variant, students will make their choice during the registration period as well.

10. Can we choose cohorts based on faculty as well?

No. Students can only select a cohort based on the mode of delivery and not the faculty assigned to the cohort.

11. Will ALU eventually stop the online variants of all modules?

At this point in time, the university has decided to deliver modules in a blended format which includes online and in-person variants.

12. What will happen if the number of students who choose an in-person mode is less than the set threshold?

If the number of students who sign up for the in-person variant is less than 15 the in-person variant will not be delivered for that trimester, and students would be enrolled in the online version of the module, instead. This is to ensure that the in-person experience and faculty resources are optimized. If the entire class is less than 25, then the entire class needs to select an in person variant for it to be delivered in that format. If students are distributed, the cohort will be online.

13. Will students retaking a module with the in-person option have the option to choose their mode of delivery?

Yes. If a student is doing a retake for a module that has an in-person variant, they can choose the in-person option.

14. Will there be any changes to grading policies or assessments based on the mode of delivery?

No. Attendance and engagement will be graded in the same way for both modalities. Assessment will also be the same and will be done via Canvas for both modalities.

15. Will in-person classes be recorded for students who miss a session?

No, in-person classes will not be recorded.

16. Will extracurricular activities be expanded to accommodate the increased number of students on campus?

Yes, the Student Life team in collaboration with student leaders will create new extra-curricular activities for students. We will like to see many more student-led activities on campus and invite students to propose events they wish to collaborate with Student Life on or host them directly.

17. Will in-person students have priority access to internship or networking opportunities?

No, all students will have the same opportunities regardless of their choice of mode of delivery. Note that each internship opportunity offered by ALU or external partners has its own criteria independent of how many modules a student has opted to take in person, and students will be selected for those opportunities based on those criteria. In-person networking opportunities, as well as masterclasses on campus organized by the Global Leadership Experiences team, will be announced to the entire student body or to students with interests relevant to or linked to the opportunity. This process will not be changed. The team will also provide options for hybrid or online-only experiences to ensure participation for students outside of Rwanda.

18. Will ALU provide any financial support to students opting for in-person learning?

No. The university will not provide financial support to students who opt for in-person variants of selected modules. We recognize that switching to in-person delivery may have financial implications for some students, which is why we are committed to maintaining the same learning quality for online and in-person variants.

19. Do we have the option to choose in-person or online classes at the end of every term, or do we choose it once and attend the classes this way until graduation?

Yes, students will need to select their preferred delivery format for modules every trimester during registration period for that trimester.

20. In the event where there is an unprecedented change in location of the student from Rwanda to another country, what would happen to the student's classes? Would they be allowed to switch to online classes?

This will be dealt with on a case-by-case basis. Only exceptional cases will be excused.

21. Would it be possible to introduce more in-person classes for additional modules in the future?

Yes, the University will release in-person variants for more modules in September 2025 and Jan 2026.

If you have a question that hasn't been answered, please submit it [here](#).

ANNEX

List of Courses with Online Variant in Sep 2025 release

Bachelor's Entrepreneurial Leadership

Course	Trimester	Modality	Course Type
Reflective Thinking	Tri 1	Face-to-Face	Foundation
Learning Processes	Tri 1	Face-to-Face	Foundation
E-lab	Tri 1	Face-to-Face	
Self-directed Learning (SDL)	Tri 1	Face-to-Face	
Professional Skills Lab 1	Tri 2	Virtual	Skills Immersion
Building Startups & Creating Employment in Emerging Markets	Tri 2	Two Variants (In-person + Virtual)	Core Methods
Complex Problem Solving	Tri 2	Two Variants (In-person + Virtual)	Core Methods
Intro to Grand Challenges and Opportunities	Tri 2	Virtual	Mission Pathway
Communicating for Impact	Tri 3	Virtual	Foundation
Self Leadership & Team Dynamics	Tri 3	Virtual	Foundation
Skills Immersion 1	Tri 3	Remote/Immersive	Skills Immersion
GCGO Electives (Select 4)	Tri 4	Virtual	Mission Pathway
Africa's Leaders	Tri 4	Two Variants (In-person + Virtual)	Core Methods
Creativity and Innovation	Tri 4	Two Variants (In-person + Virtual)	Core Methods

Responsible Enterprise	Tri 4	Virtual	Foundation
GCGO Electives (Select 2)	Tri 5	Virtual	Mission Pathway
Simulation: Structured Controversy	Tri 5	Virtual	Mission Pathway
Idea Generation and Future Thinking	Tri 5	Two Variants (In-person + Virtual)	Core Methods
System Thinking and Gap Analysis	Tri 5	Two Variants (In-person + Virtual)	Core Methods
Critical Thinking	Tri 5	Virtual	Foundation
Skills Immersion 2	Tri 6	Remote/Immersive	Skills Immersion
Professional Skills Lab	Tri 6	Virtual	Skills Immersion
Theory of Change and Opportunity Mapping	Tri 7	Virtual	Core Methods
Advanced Startups	Tri 7	Virtual	Core Methods
Building and Scaling Teams	Tri 7	Virtual	Mission Pathway
Self-Directed Development "Tools of the Trade 1"	Tri 7	Virtual	Mission Pathway
Quantitative Reasoning	Tri 7	Virtual	Foundation
Computational Thinking and Managing Complex Tasks	Tri 8	Virtual	Foundation
Prototyping and Go-to-market	Tri 8	Virtual	Mission Pathway
Capstone proposal and prep	Tri 8	Virtual	Mission Pathway
Self-Directed Development "Tools of the Trade 2"	Tri 8	Virtual	Mission Pathway
Africa's Leadership Imperative	Tri 9	Virtual	Mission Pathway
Mission Capstone	Tri 9	Self-directed (in-person + virtual advisory)	Mission Pathway

Bachelor's Software Engineering

Course	Trimester	Modality	Course Type
Learning Processes	Tri 1	Face-to-Face	Foundation
Reflective Thinking	Tri 1	Face-to-Face	Foundation
E-lab	Tri 1	Face-to-Face	
Self-directed Learning (SDL)	Tri 1	Face-to-Face	Foundation
Introduction to Linux and IT tools	Tri 2	Two Variants (In-person + Virtual)	Software Engineering
Introduction to Python Programming and Databases	Tri 2	Two Variants (In-person + Virtual)	Software Engineering
Self-Leadership and Team Dynamics	Tri2	Virtual	Foundation

Front-End Web Development	Tri 3	Two Variants (In-person + Virtual)	Software Engineering
Web Infrastructure	Tri 3	Two Variants (In-person + Virtual)	Software Engineering
Responsible Enterprise	Tri3	Virtual	Foundation
Communicating for Impact	Tri4	Virtual	Foundation
Enterprise Web Development	Tri 4	Virtual	Software Engineering
Foundations Project	Tri 4	Virtual	Software Engineering
Introduction to Software Engineering	Tri 5	Virtual	Software Engineering
Skills Immersion 1	Tri 5	Remote/Immersive	Skills Immersion
Mobile Application Development	Tri 6	Two Variants (In-person + Virtual)	Software Engineering
Advanced Front End Web Development [Full-Stack Web Development]	Tri 6	Two Variants (In-person + Virtual)	Full-Stack Web Development
Mathematics of Machine Learning [Machine Learning]	Tri 6	Two Variants (In-person + Virtual)	Machine Learning
Programming in C [Low Level]	Tri 6	Two Variants (In-person + Virtual)	Low Level
Programming in C# [AR/VR]	Tri 6	Two Variants (In-person + Virtual)	AR/VR
Advanced Python Programming [Full Stack Web Development]	Tri 7	Virtual	Full-Stack Web Development
Introduction to Machine Learning [Machine Learning]	Tri 7	Virtual	Machine Learning
Datastructures and Algorithmn in C [Low Level]	Tri 7	Virtual	Low Level
Introduction to Unity [AR/VR]	Tri 7	Virtual	AR/VR
Advanced Back-End Web Development [Full Stack Web Development]	Tri 7	Virtual	Full-Stack Web Development
Machine Learning Pipeline [Machine Learning]	Tri 7	Virtual	Machine Learning
Linux Programming [Low Level]	Tri 7	Virtual	Low Level
Advanced C# Programming [AR/VR]	Tri 7	Virtual	AR/VR
React Development [Full Stack Web Development]	Tri 8	Virtual	Full-Stack Web Development
Machine Learning Techniques - 1 [Machine Learning]	Tri 8	Virtual	Machine Learning
Introduction to Blockchain Development [	Tri 8	Virtual	Low Level

Low Level]			
AR/VR Development with Unity I [AR/VR]	Tri 8	Virtual	AR/VR
AR/VR Development with Unity I [AR/VR]	Tri 8	In-person	AR/VR
Advanced DevOps [Full Stack Web Development]	Tri 8	Virtual	Full-Stack Web Development
Machine Learning Techniques II [Machine Learning]	Tri 8	Virtual	Machine Learning
Blockchain and Application [Low Level]	Tri 8	Virtual	Low Level
AR/VR Development with Unity II [AR/VR]	Tri 8	Virtual	AR/VR
AR/VR Development with Unity II [AR/VR]	Tri 8	In-person	AR/VR
Pre-capstone*	Tri 8	Virtual	Mission Pathway
Ethics In Software Engineering	Tri 9	Virtual	Software Engineering
Mission Capstone	Tri 9	Virtual	Mission Pathway